

Tiffany Mao

PRODUCT DESIGNER

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Product designer who ships her own front-end. I make consumer products that feel playful and alive — 0→1 app flows, design systems, educational games, and physical interfaces — shaped by work across a seed-stage startup, Meta, and freelance clients.

EXPERIENCE	Freelance Product Designer Aug 2024 — Present · Remote	
	— Led 0→1 design for a pre-seed AI startup as the only designer — brand, design system, and the entire MVP flow from blank page to shippable product. — Redesigned the explore page for a YC-backed no-code game-modding platform, rebuilding discovery around how players and creators actually browse: SEO-informed IA plus community browsing patterns. — Rebuilt a software studio's site with dark/light mode and redesigned its pricing page, turning a broken conversion flow into a working one.	
	Design Engineer / Cocoon Apr 2023 — Jun 2024 · San Francisco	
	— Owned UX for pregnancy & disability leave across 3 core flows — user interviews, legal alignment, and production React components — serving 50+ companies. — Built Cocoon's first design system: 20+ shared components adopted by 15 engineers, letting a 6-person team ship consistent UI without a designer in every loop. — Led the company's first brand refresh, bringing visual consistency and ADA compliance to every user touchpoint. — Drove alignment across design, engineering, legal, and ops through stakeholder interviews and design reviews, managing sign-off across 3 departments from kickoff to launch.	
	Software Engineer / Meta Sep — Nov 2022 · Menlo Park	
PLAY & PRODUCT	— Revamped Android UI components for Facebook's video sharing team, improving legibility and color accessibility across sizes at consumer scale. — Designed and built React components for an internal pipeline tool, cutting user-error friction in a high-volume engineering workflow.	
	iOS Software Engineer Intern / Meta Jun — Aug 2021 · Remote	
	— Shipped cross-posting components for Facebook and Instagram Stories, delivering a design-accurate eligibility page to millions of users. — Audited Figma plugin graphics for color and text accessibility to meet WCAG compliance.	
	Graft! / cozy game about grafting plants 3rd Place Judge's Award from IndieCade Game Jam · 2026	
	— Sole designer on a 6-person jam team — owned every user interaction and screen: menus, minigames, letters, and trait panels, set the hand-drawn visual direction, and built the UI prefabs in Unity for engineers to wire up.	
SKILLS	The Wonder Workshop / cozy crafting game for kids UC Berkeley x Common Sense Media · 2025	
	— Co-designed a crafting game for ages 9–11 around a zero-failure-state model — kids stay engaged through intrinsic motivation rather than punishment mechanics. — Developed 3 critter companions, lesson structures, and core loops that teach color, texture, and form through play; designed scrapbook and order-book mechanics that build creative confidence without prescribing a right answer.	
	PalBits / customizable game controller UC Berkeley · 2025	
	— Designed a modular handheld controller for ages 8–12 where swappable physical parts evolve your in-game character; modeled the parts in Fusion 360. — Synthesized industrial design, hardware integration, and game mechanics into one experience balancing self-expression with usability.	
	Design	Product & interaction design, 0→1 product, visual design, design systems, game & play design, branding
EDUCATION	Research	User interviews, usability testing, wireframing, prototyping, accessibility (WCAG / ADA)
	Build	HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React, p5.js · Figma, Framer, Adobe CC, Procreate, Claude Code
EDUCATION	University of California, Berkeley — Master of Design (MDes) Expected Dec 2026	
	University of California, Berkeley — B.A. Computer Science 2022	